# Answers and talk notes

Equations and Inequalities Problem Solving

### What your student is learning

Tonight the decision comes first: does this situation give ONE exact value, or a LIMIT? That picks equation or inequality.

## Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **A.** split equally, each, is. split equally, each, is usually point to an equation.
2. **B.** A box can hold at most 12 books.. A box can hold at most 12 books, because at most gives a limit.
3. **C.** Six friends share 24 stickers equally.. Six friends share 24 stickers equally, because sharing equally gives one exact amount.
4. **B.** 4t = 28. 4t = 28, because the total is one exact amount.
5. **C.** 3g ≤ 30. 3g ≤ 30, because the spending must be $30 or less.

### Talk about it

Which pile has a limit, and which has one exact value? How do you know?

### Home mission

Find two notes at home: one with an exact amount ("the total is $28") and one with a limit ("at most 3 snacks"). Ask your student which is an equation and which is an inequality, and which words decided it.

### When they are stuck, ask

- Does this give one exact answer, or a limit?
- Which words in the problem told you that?
- Could more than one number work here?

### Try not to say

- One number in the problem means use an equation.
- Equations and inequalities are interchangeable.
- Write the equation and add the limit later.